lived and taught at this monastery; but it's hard to be certain based on available evidence).

In a monastery nearby, we're struck by the beauty of a sculpture 'depicting the horse of the prince Siddhartha returning in grief after renunciation'. Inside another monastery is a 'beautiful carved moonstone' at the entrance of a *chaitya*, or Buddhist temple, and a 'nunnery, store rooms, sculpture workshop, foreman's seat, [and] a urinal'. Inscriptions at a monastic complex indicate that it was founded by Mahadevi Bhatideva, mother of the third king of the Ikshvaku Dynasty; another complex was founded by Kodabalisiri, sister of the same king. Other monasteries show 'an attached kitchen and refectory with courtyard' and 'an interesting drainage system'.[10]

It's now clear to us that the locals love to sculpt in stone. Their Buddhist sculpture, carved in greenish limestone, abounds with people, gods, fauna, flora and symbolic forms. On the walls of their religious and public buildings, the sculptors depict what they see unfolding around them: dancers and musicians performing; children at play; courtly events; people assembled to drink; wrestlers contesting. On one panel we see a woman in a bathtub, on another men bathe leisurely in masonry tanks, as attendants pour water from cisterns over their bodies. The panels also depict war scenes, *yaksha*s and *yakshi*s, sundry devotees, ornaments, rituals, etc. Though Ikshvaku art continues the Amravathi style of the Satavahanas, we also notice occasional Roman artistic influences in the drapery, coiffures and body shapes. We can see that the art and architecture of Gandhara, Mathura and the Sakas (Indo-Scythians) have left their mark too. A finely carved pillar, for instance, carries a charming depiction of two Sakas in their distinct style of dress.[11]

Back near the citadel and along the riverbank, the eighteen or more Brahminical temples may be the first such cluster built in south India—mostly Shaiva, a few Vaishnava, or both. The smaller temples only have a shrine chamber; the larger ones also have a pillared hall in front, with finely cut, sculpted and polished pillars. A notable pair of ornamental temple pillars, *chitra stambha*s, shows two finely carved elephants on the move, cockfights, bulls and rams, and a mysterious Amazonian woman holding a